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THE FOREIGN SERVICE
OF THE
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

SECRET

FJ 1023101/13

ADDRESS OFFICIAL COMMUNICATIONS TO

American Embassy
1, Grosvenor Square,
London, W.1.

November 12, 1951

Dear Rob:

For background in connection with Livie Merchant's visit, there is quoted below the text of a telegram addressed to Secretary Acheson by Ambassador Dulles.

"As I think you know, John Sparkman, Alex Smith and I plan to be in Japan about mid-December with view to getting in best possible position to handle treaty ratifications in January-February. A major aspect will be probable future relations of Japan with Formosa which has been greatly confused by equivocal statements made by Yoshida in course of Diet debates. Some of his statements will greatly disturb Congress and have bad effect on treaty ratification. In view of what Yoshida has said feel it indispensible that when in Tokyo three of us should get some indication of Japanese intention more reliable than Yoshida's recent public utterances which slant both ways. Without that, Sparkman and Smith will be in a difficult position to handle treaties in Senate.

"It seems to me highly desirable that first effort should be endeavor clear situation with UK, particularly having in mind new government may take somewhat different approach than labor government and might not be opposed to Japanese Government aiming at least limited peace treaty with Nationalist Government which would be operative within the de facto authority of that government, both territorially and as voting member of UN in which

and in

R. H. Scott, Esq., C.M.G., C.B.E.,
Assistant Under-Secretary of State,
Foreign Office,
S.W.1.

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and in organs of which Japan seeks membership. Although we have been discussing such limited treatment with Chinese Embassy and Taipei for many months, we are not yet clear whether Generalissimo will accept limited treaty but if Japanese propose it and he refused, then responsibility will be his.

"Our practical suggestion is that Merchant, now on leave, but who thoroughly familiar with entire background, should promptly go London for discussion with Foreign Office which might be consummated between Dening and me at Tokyo so that we could present united front there and avoid conflict which would be embarrassing and which Japs would tend to capitalize on for their own purposes. Policy and program here outlined has approval of Europe, Far East and Matthews. If you concur, we would appreciate being promptly advised and also ask you to mention matter to Eden with view his seeing Merchant in London after Merchant has first approached Foreign Office officials. Feel importance of trying continue united US-UK front in Japan justifies Eden giving this matter personal attention. We do not however feel you need discuss details with him at this time as probably it would be better to have first discussion take place with Foreign Office officials without whose advice we would not expect Eden to commit himself."

Livie arrives on Pan American Flight 100 due at London Airport at 10:30 tomorrow.

Sincerely yours

Arthur R. Ringwalt

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